

Rhosyn

WHENCE ALL MONSTERS COME



MENTAL TIER 3

The change is a magical accident. In the process of attempting to repair itself, Onyx's bestiary tried to replace its damaged entries with new ones, but ended up latching onto the player and binding them as a familiar. Warped by the otherworldly magic of the Pelorium, the player is in the process of becoming the kind of monsters that calls the realm home. If they can't find a way to break the bond, the player will be permanently bound to the bestiary and its owner as a familiar monster.

MOVES

Game Face: Whenever a player is chosen to do battle, they take one change, distributed as they choose.

Peloric Healing: Whenever a player is knocked out, they are temporarily banished to the Pelorium, where they recover any lost attribute points, but also take a number of changes equal to half of the number of attribute points healed, rounded down. From here, Onyx can re-summon them.

Unfamiliar Monsters: If Onyx tries to bind any monsters besides the player, the binding fails, and the player takes a change in any attribute.

ONYX



CAST

ONYX (THEY/THEM)

"I see that you're also here for the legendary Monoceros! In that case, we have no choice but to do battle!"

A rival of the player, a witch at about the same skill level as them. While they make a show of being antagonistic toward the player, as far as Onyx is concerned, it's all in good fun. Onyx is very passionate about witchcraft, and enjoys collecting rare monsters, thus their interest in the Monoceros. They don't actually mean the player any serious harm, and when an accident leads to them being bound to Onyx as a familiar, Onyx will do their best to get them help.

RHOSYN (SHE/HER)

"My greatest rivals, soon to be my most powerful monsters! What a delightful thought! Hehehehehe!"

Rhosyn considers the player her greatest rival in the field of witchcraft, but the player barely knows she exists. Rhosyn is determined to become the most formidable witch in all of Remia, and is willing to go to extreme lengths to achieve that goal. She seeks the Monoceros for the power it is reputed to have, but when she finds out about the player's predicament, she leaps at the opportunity to steal their power for herself.

MASON (HE/HIM)

"You pipsqueaks really want to fight? Okay, bring it on! You can't beat my Antlion!"

A slightly more experienced witch, though he's still a long way from being top-tier, despite his cocky and brash nature. His familiar in battle is an Antlion.

PERRY (HE/HIM)

"Look, mate, I have no idea what the hell those bandit girls have going on, but I wanna be very clear that I ain't a part of it."

A witch at about the same experience level as the player. He has a glowing magical prosthetic eye infused with carefully-warded Peloric energies. His favored familiar and constant companion outside of battle is a Hercinia capable of mimicking human speech, with a penchant for foul language.

SIR ANTARES (HE/HIM)

"Another fan? Bah! You kids just don't take a hint, do you? Well, never mind that. Care for a spot of scallion tea?"

A famous and somewhat eccentric witch with a long and storied career, Sir Antares has long since retired to live in a cottage in the Leaftide Forest. While he is sick of dealing with annoying fans, once you win him over, Sir Antares is friendly, if slightly scatterbrained.

THE BANDIT SQUAD – TERRY, CHERRY, AND MARY (SHE/HER)

"Terry, Cherry, and Mary, at your service—to rob you senseless! Aren't we scary? Attack, faerie!"

Terry, Cherry, and Mary are a group of thieves who dabble in witchcraft. They might be interested in the Monoceros' power, but only to streamline what they already do for a living: ambushing novice witches, defeating them in battle, and stealing all their valuables. If the player has a name that rhymes (even loosely) with theirs, the trio may try to invite them to join the squad. Their favored familiars for battle are faerie-type monsters, such as Kelpies, Barghests, Brownies, Pixies, and Dullahans.

THE MONOCEROS (IT/ITS)

"Are you here to try to bind me? I warn you, many have tried, but none have succeeded."

A legendary and incredibly rare monster of great power that is rumored to dwell in the Leaftide Forest. The Monoceros is a stockier cousin to the Unicorn, and has similar magic, including the ability to cast and dispel curses. It could be just the thing the player needs to escape being bound to Onyx.

INTRO

In the land of Remia, witches do battle using familiars, wild monsters bound to their will and life force, which are summoned and controlled using bestiaries, enchanted encyclopedias of monsters. When a familiar falls in battle, they return to the Pelorium, the otherworldly realm whence all monsters ultimately come and which they ultimately return to, in order to heal before being re-summoned. By using these proxies, Remian witches steer clear of the destructive force of using their powers at their full potential, a force that nearly destroyed Remia in the past, and which is tightly regulated by the Sorcerers' Council.

The player is a novice witch who has come to the remote, enchanted, and labyrinthine Leaftide Forest in search of the Monoceros. The player isn't the only witch who has heard the rumors that there's a Monoceros in the forest, though.

Some time after entering the forest, the player passes through a steep canyon. As they do, they're ambushed by Onyx, who blocks their way and challenges them to a battle. Onyx is using an Amphiptere, a rare dragon variant. Despite its rarity, it goes down fairly easily, but in the process, it lights Onyx's bestiary aflame with an enchanted fire. In the chaos that ensues as Onyx tries to extinguish it, it lets out a burst of magic that affects both them and the player.

THE CHANGE

The player finds themselves transported to the Pelorium, where they feel the realm's arcane energies invading and warping their body. Soon enough, they feel drawn back to the human world, but something is wrong. They've been bound to Onyx's damaged bestiary (and by extension, Onyx herself) as a familiar, and are slowly becoming monsters as a result. Onyx has lost the rest of their monsters to the fire, and meanwhile, the player's bestiaries is unusable due to the altered state of its owners. At this point, the player should take 2-3 changes, distributed as they choose.

BUILDUP

Onyx is disturbed by this development and wants to help the player, but this deep into the forest, it's hard to reach outside help. Onyx thinks that Sir Antares, who lives in the forest, could help if they can find him. To make it worse, the woods are full of hostile witches and roaming monsters. The player has no choice but to fight by Onyx's side as they seek a way to undo the binding before it's too late.

The player's bestiary entry changes based on the number of changes they have taken. In addition, as their bestiary entry changes, the way they're perceived initially by outsiders on first meeting changes. At higher levels, outsiders will be surprised that they are capable of speech. However, they can be made to understand the truth with an explanation.

Eventually, the player will reach Sir Antares' cottage. Tired of being challenged to battles by his many fans, he has posted a pair of guard Gryphons outside. The player will have to either distract them, defeat them, or find a way to sneak past them.

CLIMAX

Dealing with Sir Antares is a bit of a handful, but if the player wins him over, he will agree to help them. He thinks the best bet for solving the player's problem lies in the power of the Monoceros. He's heard the rumors of the beast's presence in the forest, but having given up on battling, has had little interest in seeing if there's anything to those rumors. He will refuse to accompany the player, insisting he's too old for adventure, but gives them an enchanted compass that points toward Peloric energies, and directs them toward the heart of the forest, where the Monoceros is said to dwell. Rhosyn, who is spying on the group, overhears this, and will follow the player to their destination in secret.

The Monoceros lives in an enchanted glade in the deepest part of the forest. If the player is changed enough to understand its words, it will speak to them, and if they agree to leave it be, will offer to break their curse. Otherwise, a battle will ensue. The Monoceros won't allow them to bind it without a fight. To make things more complicated, Rhosyn will show up, hoping to bind both the player and the Monoceros to her will.

ENDINGS

If the player is able to lift the curse before reaching Permanence, they will be unbound and the changes will revert. Otherwise, they can either choose to stay bound to Onyx or be unbound and risk being banished to the Pelorium. The Monoceros might also offer to unbind them without banishment, if they have its cooperation. Of course, the player may also end up bound to Rhosyn, either by choice or against their will. If the latter occurs, Sir Antares may try to intervene.

BESTIARY ENTRIES FOR PLAYER MONSTERS

Salamander: A large amphibian covered in white fur. It has powerful flame abilities. It can withstand the hottest of temperatures, and seems to enjoy being on fire.

Serra: An amphibious fish with multicolored scales and a wicked sawblade-like crest on its head that it uses as a weapon. It has powerful wings, and is capable of flying through the air at great speeds for extended periods. It can even hover.

Wolpertinger: A more dangerous relative of the Jackelope, the Wolpertinger is a rabbit-like animal with bird-like wings and talons, antlers, and enormous fangs. What it lacks in magic, it makes up for in bloodlust.

MORE COMMON MONSTERS

Jackelope: A small but aggressive and dangerous animal resembling a rabbit with the horns of an antelope. Like a parrot, it can mimic human voices.

Centicore: An antelope-like creature with large horns that it can rotate independently in battle.

Jaculus: A small wyvern that is fond of throwing itself at its foes with great force.

Seps: A bipedal serpent with acidic venom. While it can also spit its venom, direct bites are extremely dangerous.

Antlion: A creature resembling a cross between a lion and an enormous ant. It is noted for its great strength.

Imp: A small floating humanoid monster capable of levitating off the ground. They're excellent climbers, and are fond of playing tricks.

Pantera: A cat-like creature with a rainbow-colored hide. Its breath contains a poison that dazes its prey.

Scitalis: A snake-like creature that distracts its prey with a dazzling threat display.

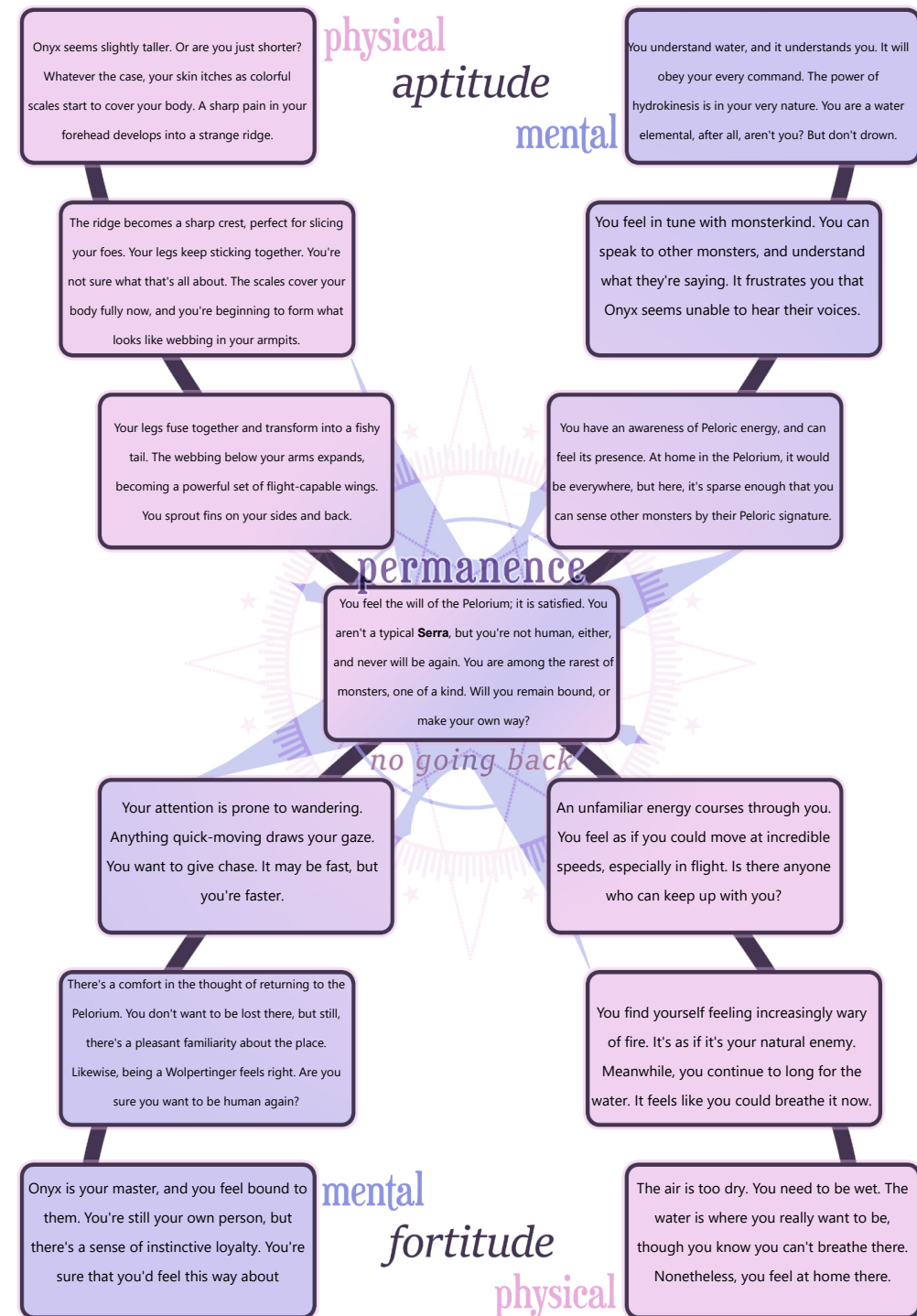
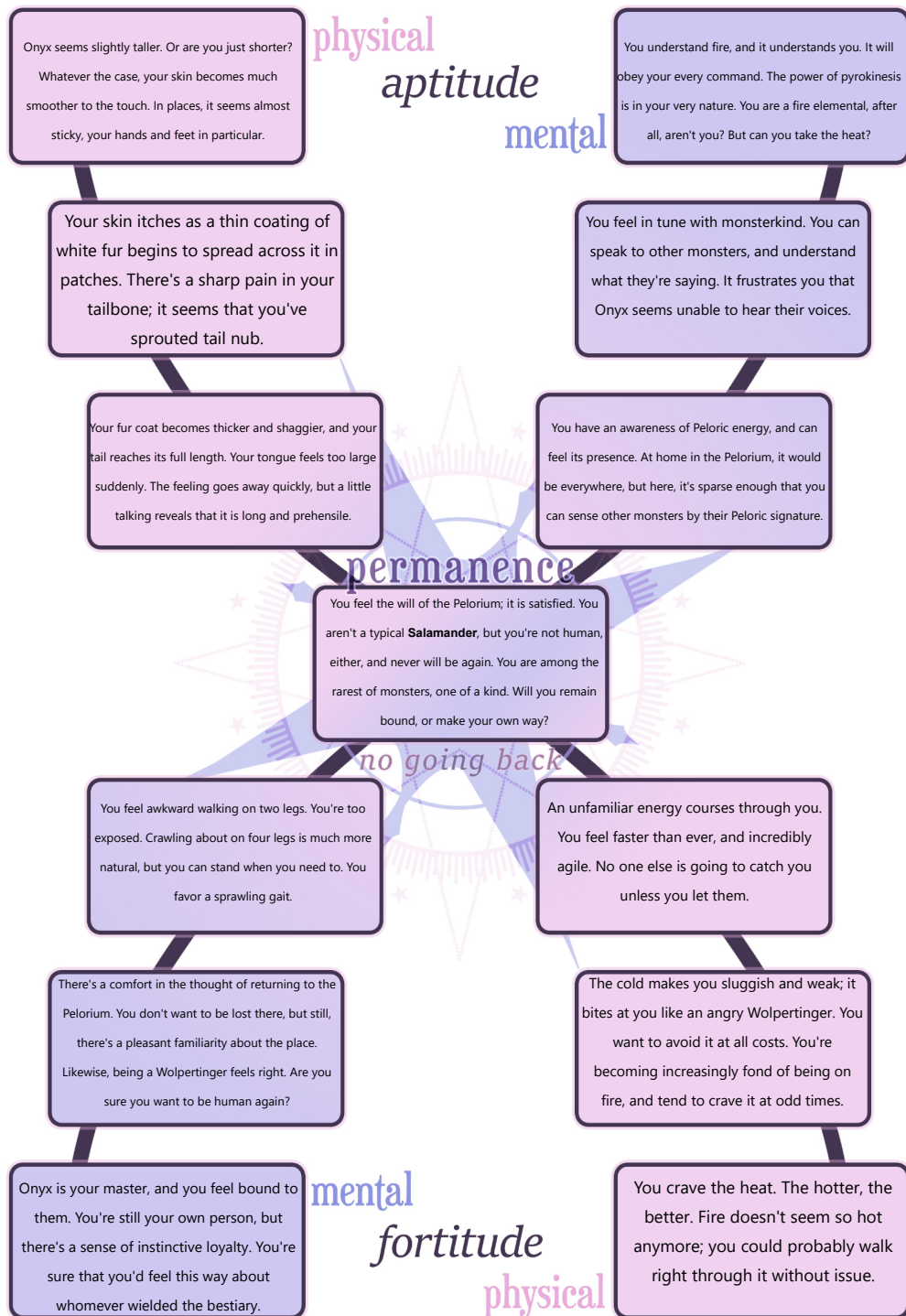
Ball-tailed cat: A cat-like creature with a spiked club on its tail.

Hercinia: A bird-like creature that glows as brightly as the sun.

Martlet: A bird-like creature with seemingly endless stamina, spending its whole life on the wing due to a lack of feet.

Change count	Effects	Bestiary entry
3	Initially perceived by others as human	Human: A human witch bound as a familiar. A clade of derived primates, humans foolishly believe themselves to be the dominant species on Eumundi. Their combat abilities are limited, and their magical abilities are typically restricted by a binding put in place by the Sorcerers' Council. Without the binding, their abilities are greater, but still pale in comparison to true power.
4-7	Initially perceived by others as an unknown monster type	Human (?): A human affected by Peloric energies. Because of humans' inherent weakness, they cannot withstand extensive exposure to this power, and may suffer adverse effects, such as loss of species identity. As this instability resolves itself, they will become more powerful.
8+	Initially perceived by others as an unusual specimen of their designated monster type	[See appropriate monster entry]

0-3	The player encounters a wild monster.
4-5	The player comes across a crashed carriage in the woods. It turns out to be a trap set by the Bandit Squad.
6-7	The player find sa campsite. The campers are wary, as other witches have been a nuisance for them, and only one of their party has any experience in witchcraft.
8-9	Onyx is running low on supplies, and needs to find more.
10-11	The player reaches a clearing containing the cottage of a local woodsman. He might be able to give supplies or directions if the player can persuade him that they're trustworthy.
12-13	The player finds an abandoned campsite left by one of the other witches.
14-15	The player comes to the banks of a small river that runs through the forest. They will need to either find a way to cross it, or follow its course.
16-17	The player finds a deep canyon blocking their way. A sturdy wooden bridge spans it, but Mason is waiting on the other side and will block their progress.
18-19	The player realizes that someone is following them. If the player can catch them, it turns out to be Rhosyn.
20-21	The player comes across the ruins of a collapsed stone tower. The outer walls of the lower three floors are the only things remaining. If they try to explore the ruins, Perry will ambush them.



physical
aptitude
mental

Your skin itches as fur begins to grow across it in patches. Your canines ache, becoming huge fangs, and a pair of strange bumps appear on your forehead.

Your lip becomes creased and your increasingly sensitive nose V-shapes as you sprout thin whiskers. As your hearing improves, your ears shift to the top of your head and elongate into a lagomorphic shape.

As the fur spreads further, a sharp pain at the base of your spine informs you of your new rabbit-like tail. The bumps on your head become small antlers, and your hands become sharp avian talons.

You feel in tune with monsterkind. You can speak to other monsters, and understand what they're saying. It frustrates you that Onyx seems unable to hear their voices.

Fur now covers your body. Your antlers continue growing, now huge and imposing. Finally, you sprout a majestic pair of eagle-like wings on your back which let you fly.

You have an awareness of Peloric energy, and can feel its presence. At home in the Pelorium, it would be everywhere, but here, it's sparse enough that you can sense other monsters by their Peloric signature.

permanence

You feel the Pelorium's satisfaction. You're not a normal **Wolpertinger**, but you're also not human, and never will be again. You're among the rarest of monsters, one of a kind. Will you remain bound, or make your own way?

no going back

You find yourself feeling just as capable on four legs as two. Four is almost more comfortable. Your temper flares regularly, and your bad mood is not helped by your new rodent-like incisors, which will start to ache if you don't use them.

You feel a rush of energy through your body, granting incredible speed, agility, and stamina. Your attacks are like lightning, sharp and fast.

There's a comfort in the thought of returning to the Pelorium. You don't want to be lost there, but still, there's a pleasant familiarity about the place. Likewise, being a Wolpertinger feels right. Are you sure you want to be human again?

As you continue to get smaller, you feel a rush of newfound strength course through your veins. You may be small, but your foes will underestimate you at your peril.
Take +1 to PA draws.

Onyx is your master, and you feel bound to them. You're still your own person, but there's a sense of instinctive loyalty. You're sure that you'd feel this way about whomever wielded the bestiary.

mental
fortitude
physical

Everything seems a lot bigger suddenly. You're pretty sure you've shrunk, and you're kind of aggravated about it.